

Business & Operating Model

Owner	Executive Leadership / Operations
Effective date	September 2026
Applies to	Northstar IT operating structure, management processes, systems, and reporting

Executive Overview

Northstar IT is a B2B technology company that sells Northstar ServiceOps, a SaaS service-management and operations platform for small and midsize IT service providers. Recurring software revenue is supported by implementation, data migration, training, consulting, and integration services.

The operating model is built around one core principle: acquire the right customers, implement them successfully, drive product adoption, support them reliably, retain and expand recurring revenue, and use connected operating data to make timely management decisions.

Workforce	Customer Accounts	Active Customers	Current ARR
110	225	196	\$7.9M

Strategic Posture

- Growth-stage company with expanding recurring revenue and a continued focus on operating leverage.
- B2B SaaS and professional services model, with subscriptions as the core revenue engine and services supporting adoption and complex customer needs.
- Integrated operating data across customer, workforce, service, support, billing, and finance functions.
- Management focus on balancing growth with implementation capacity, support quality, product adoption, customer retention, and financial discipline.

Management Questions

- Are we growing recurring revenue at a rate the delivery organization can support?
- Which customers, plans, and services create the strongest long-term value?
- Where are implementation delays, support demand, or low adoption increasing churn risk?
- Are staffing levels and labor costs aligned with customer demand and service commitments?
- Where are budget variances signaling a process, capacity, pricing, or execution problem?
- What should leadership change now to improve margin, retention, service quality, and scalability?

Business Model

Northstar ServiceOps

Northstar ServiceOps supports service-management and operational workflows for small and midsize IT service providers. Plan tiers increase automation, reporting, workflow capability, and support for multi-team and multi-location operations.

Plan	Monthly Base	Included Seats	Extra Seat	Positioning
Starter	\$899	10	\$79	Small IT providers
Professional	\$2,499	30	\$69	Growing teams with more automation needs
Scale	\$5,499	75	\$59	Multi-team and multi-location organizations

Additional Revenue Streams

- Add-ons: Advanced Analytics, Asset Management, Security & Compliance, API & Integrations, and Single Sign-On.
- Professional services: Implementation, Data Migration, Training, and Consulting.

Customer Profile

The customer base contains 225 historical accounts, with 196 active as of the current model date. Customers are segmented as Small, Lower Mid-Market, and Mid-Market organizations across several industries. Northstar competes primarily on workflow fit, implementation quality, service reliability, reporting, and product adoption.

Organization & Accountability

Function	Headcount	Primary Accountability
Executive	4	Strategy, operating priorities, technology direction, finance, people leadership
Sales & Account Management	16	Pipeline, new business, account ownership, expansion, commercial relationship
Service Desk	33	Ticket intake, triage, SLA management, resolution, escalation, customer support
Field Services	15	Implementation, deployment, onsite work, and project delivery
Network & Infrastructure	14	Technical delivery, integrations, infrastructure, and complex escalation
Software & Data	14	Product development, data, reporting, and internal technical capability
Finance	7	Billing, receivables, budgeting, financial reporting, and management analysis
People & Administration	7	HR, workforce administration, policy, recruiting, training support, and administration

Reporting relationships establish accountability. Cross-functional ownership determines whether the customer lifecycle works. Customer outcomes span Sales, Implementation, Support, Product, Finance, and leadership.

Core Responsibility Model

Process	Primary Owner	Key Partners	Key Control	Output
Sales pipeline	Sales	Executive / Finance	Stage discipline and pricing guardrails	Qualified bookings
Implementation	Field / Technical Delivery	Sales / Customer Success	Scope, target go-live, hours	Successful go-live
Customer support	Service Desk	Technical teams / Customer Success	Priority, SLA, escalation	Resolved issue and CSAT
Renewal / expansion	Account Management	Support / Product / Finance	Adoption, service health, commercial review	Retained or expanded ARR
Monthly reporting	Finance / Operations	All functional leaders	Data quality and close checklist	P&L, BvA, KPIs

Workforce planning	People / Operations	Finance / functional leaders	Capacity, skills, and cost review	Hiring and development decisions
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Core Operating Processes

Customer Lifecycle

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Lead	Opportunity	Closed Won	Implementation	Active Use	Support	Renew / Expand

Commercial history, implementation outcomes, product usage, support experience, billing, and renewal or churn events are retained across the customer relationship.

Support Lifecycle

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Ticket Created	Triage	Priority + SLA	Assign	Resolve / Escalate	Close	CSAT

Support data supports analysis of ticket volume, priority, resolution time, SLA performance, escalation, agent workload, and customer satisfaction.

Employee Lifecycle

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Requisition	Hire	Onboard	Train	Perform	Develop / Move	Exit

Workforce data includes recruiting, employee master data, job and compensation history, training, attendance, PTO, and exits.

Management Reporting Cycle

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Collect	Validate	Close	Analyze	Review	Decide	Track Action

Management reporting is expected to lead to a decision, named ownership, and follow-through.

Systems & Data Landscape

Source Domain	Primary Information
HRIS / Compensation	Employees, job history, pay, workforce snapshots, position bands
ATS	Recruiting requisitions and hiring activity
Timekeeping	Attendance, overtime, PTO
LMS	Training history and completion
CRM	Customer accounts, contacts, sales opportunities
Subscription / Billing	Plans, add-ons, subscription events, invoices, payments
Customer Success	Onboarding and implementation outcomes
Support	Tickets, SLA performance, escalation
Product Analytics	Monthly usage and adoption
PSA / Projects	Professional-services projects and time entries
Finance	Chart of accounts, cost centers, expenses, budgets, vendors

Data Architecture

1	2	3	4	5	6
Raw CSV Exports	Staging Tables	Validation / Mapping	Normalized MariaDB	SQL / Views	BI + Application

Source data is preserved as received. Data quality issues are documented, transformation rules are defined, and cleaned values remain traceable to the original record.

Management Reporting & KPIs

Decision Area	Representative KPIs
Growth	MRR, ARR, New ARR, Expansion ARR, Contraction ARR, Churned ARR, Win Rate, Sales Cycle Length
Customer	Logo Churn, Revenue Retention, Product Adoption, Active User %, CSAT, Support Tickets per Customer
Delivery	Time to Go Live, Implementation On Time %, Project Hours vs Budget, Billable Utilization, Escalation Rate
Support	Ticket Volume, SLA Attainment, Resolution Hours, Backlog, Priority Mix, Repeat or Escalated Issues
People	Headcount, Turnover, Overtime, Absence, Training Completion, Time to Fill, Internal Movement
Finance	Revenue Mix, Gross Margin, Operating Income, Budget Variance, A/R Aging, Customer Profitability, Project Margin

Cross-Functional Analysis

- Do customers with slower implementations show lower adoption, more support demand, or higher churn?
- Which plans or customer segments generate the most support workload relative to recurring revenue?
- Are expansion opportunities concentrated among customers with stronger adoption and CSAT?
- Which delivery teams or roles are experiencing overtime, workload, or staffing pressure as customer demand grows?
- Which professional-services projects are profitable after labor cost is considered?
- Are budget misses caused by revenue shortfall, cost growth, staffing, service inefficiency, or a planning assumption that proved wrong?

Governance & Controls

Artifact	Purpose	Northstar Use
Org chart	Reporting structure and span of responsibility	Maintained as organization changes
Customer lifecycle map	End-to-end commercial and service journey	Defines cross-functional handoffs
Support escalation flow	Priority, SLA, escalation, closure	Defines service escalation expectations
RACI / responsibility matrix	Cross-functional ownership	Clarifies decision and execution roles
SOP library index	Controlled list of core procedures	Provides document control
Selected SOPs	Customer onboarding, support escalation, month-end reporting, data quality	Standardizes recurring work
Policy framework	Data access, change control, documentation, training and compliance	Defines minimum operating controls
Risk register	Operational, customer, people, vendor, security, and financial risks	Tracks ownership and mitigation
Succession / key-role continuity	Coverage for critical leadership and technical roles	Reduces continuity risk
Business continuity framework	System outage, vendor failure, staffing disruption	Defines response and recovery expectations
KPI dictionary	Metric definition, owner, source, calculation, cadence	Supports consistent reporting

Technical Design Standards

- Preserve history for subscriptions, job changes, pricing, ownership, churn, and financial activity.
- Separate raw source data from trusted normalized data.
- Use stable identifiers for employees, customers, subscriptions, projects, tickets, invoices, products, and accounts.
- Model many-to-many relationships explicitly.
- Support time-based analysis across workforce, product usage, revenue, expenses, budgets, and subscription activity.
- Protect business rules through constraints and reference tables where appropriate.
- Flag and quarantine anomalies rather than silently overwriting source values.
- Design the schema so P&L, BvA, SaaS metrics, support performance, workforce analysis, and customer profitability can be produced without spreadsheet workarounds.

Northstar IT is a fictional company used for professional portfolio demonstration.